

XIANG (CHARLIE) CHENG

Ph.D. Student in Information Systems

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Research Interests

Topics	Business Applications and Economic Impacts of Generative Artificial Intelligence
Methods	Analytical Modeling, Causal Inference, Experiment, Machine Learning and LLM Fine-tuning

Education

2024 – Present	University of Maryland – College Park, MD Ph.D. in Information Systems
2020 – 2024	Renmin University of China – Beijing, China Bachelor of Business Administration, Financial Management
Fall 2023	New York University – New York, NY Visiting Student

Research and Publications

[†] denotes presented by coauthor

Working Paper

- W1. Xiang Cheng and Wen Wang. “(How) Can LLMs Enhance Privacy Research?”
 - Major Revision at *Management Science*
 - 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting 2025 INFORMS Workshop on Data Science 2025 ICIS
- W2. Xiang Cheng and Manmohan Aseri. “Incentive Issues in Developing Factual LLMs”.
 - Under Review at *Information Systems Research*
 - 2025 UMD Faculty-Student Research Award (\$15,000)
 - 2025 BizAI[†] 2025 AI at Wharton[†]
- W3. Xiang Cheng, Raveesh Mayya, and João Sedoc. “To Err Is Human; To Annotate, SILICON? Reducing Measurement Error in LLM Annotation”. [*Working Paper Link*]
 - Preparing submission to *Management Science*
 - 2024 WITS 2025 BizAI 2025 SCECR[†] 2025 NYU-TAU Workshop 2025 CIST
- W4. Xiang Cheng and Manmohan Aseri. “Breaking AI Collusion with Consumer AI”.
 - Preparing submission
- W5. Xiang Cheng, Wen Wang, and Anindya Ghose. “LLMs for Explainable Business Decision-Making: A Reinforcement Learning Fine-Tuning Approach”.
 - Preparing submission to *Journal of Marketing Research*
 - 2025 CIST 2025 INFORMS Workshop on Data Science

Work-in-progress

- W6. Xiang Cheng, Manmohan Aseri, and Siva Viswanathan. **“LLMs and Media Market”**.
- W7. Xiang Cheng and Eaman Jahani. **“AI-Assisted Group Decision Making”**.
- W8. Xiang Cheng, Raveesh Mayya, Lanfei Shi, and Shun Ye. **“Support or Setback? Unpacking the Impact of the Small Business Badge”**. (author names in alphabetical order)
– 2024 WISE

Conference Proceedings

- P1. Xiang Cheng and Wen Wang, **“(How) Can LLMs Enhance Privacy Research?”** (2025). ICIS 2025 Proceedings.

Presentations and Talks

LLMs for Explainable Business Decision-Making: A Reinforcement Learning Fine-Tuning Approach

- Oct 2025 Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), Atlanta, GA
- Oct 2025 INFORMS Workshop on Data Science 2025, Atlanta, GA

(How) Can LLMs Enhance Privacy Research?

- Dec 2025 International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), Nashville, TN
- Oct 2025 INFORMS Workshop on Data Science 2025, Atlanta, GA
- Oct 2025 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA

Incentive Issues in Developing Factual LLMs

- May 2025 AI and the Future of Work Conference at Wharton, Philadelphia, PA
- Mar 2025 Biz AI Conference at The University of Texas at Dallas (BizAI), Dallas, TX

To Err Is Human; To Annotate, SILICON? Reducing Measurement Error in LLM Annotation

(Previous Title: From Human Annotation to LLMs: SILICON Annotation Workflow for Management Research)

- Oct 2025 Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), Atlanta, GA
- Sep 2025 Business & Generative AI Conference at Wharton, San Francisco, CA
- Sep 2025 NYU-TAU Workshop On AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation, New York, NY
- Jun 2025 Annual Symposium on Statistical Challenges in eCommerce Research (SCECR), Paphos, Cyprus
- Mar 2025 Biz AI Conference at The University of Texas at Dallas (BizAI), Dallas, TX
- Dec 2024 Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS), Bangkok, Thailand

Support or Setback? Unpacking the Impact of the Small Business Badge

- Dec 2024 Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE), Bangkok, Thailand

Honors and Scholarships

2025	Faculty-Student Research Award (with Manmohan Aseri), UMD, \$15,000
2024	International Conference Student Support Award, UMD, \$400
2024 – 2029	Graduate Assistantship and Summer Fellowship, UMD
2023	First Class for Academic Excellence (Top 1%), Renmin Univ., CNY 5,000
2022	National Undergraduate Innovative Research Project, Renmin Univ., CNY 20,000
2021 – 2022	Jingdong Scholarship for Academic Excellence (Top 1%), Renmin Univ., CNY 8,000

Academic Service

Journal Reviewer

Information Systems Research

Conference Reviewer

2025	Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS)
2025	International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)
2024	Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS)

Technical Skills

Programming Languages

Python, R, Matlab, Stata, SQL, Mathematica

Languages

English (fluent); Chinese (native)